

There is also a Diacom mode for medical professionals.

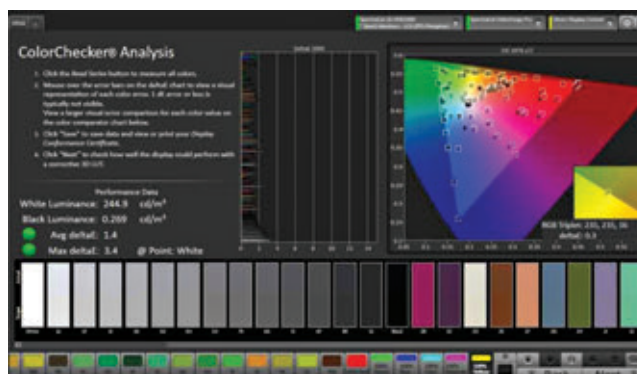
There are three modes to save your hardware calibration. If you are not invested in Portrait Display's ecosystem, you can also use BenQ's Palette Master Pro with most of the popular colourimeters for hardware calibration. The display can reproduce roughly 99% of DCI-P3, 96.5% of Adobe RGB, and 79% of BT2020 colour space, which is impressive for the price.

The monitor's greyscale response in sRGB mode was precise, but its contrast ratio of just 913:1 falls short, making it unsuitable for serious video editing. The limited contrast hampers the ability to display deep blacks and detailed shadows, which are critical for high-quality visual work. All the frequently used modes are extremely colour-accurate out of the box with an average Delta E less than the humanly perceptible value of 3.

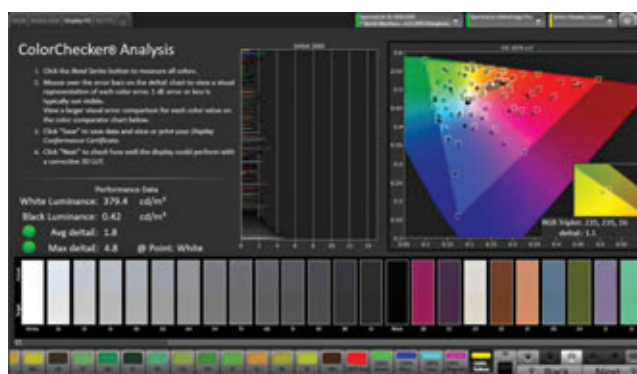
Since this is a Calman-ready monitor, we tried calibrating it using Autocal for an even tighter response. The monitor still struggles to accurately render near-black details. The BenQ SW242Q also supports HDR10 and we measured a peak brightness of around 380 nits. The colour accuracy is again excellent with HDR but the dynamic range and contrast are not enough for an impactful experience. Still, HDR support was useful whenever we needed to watch HDR content. This monitor isn't designed for gaming or motion handling, which is evident in its performance.

BenQ ScreenBar Halo

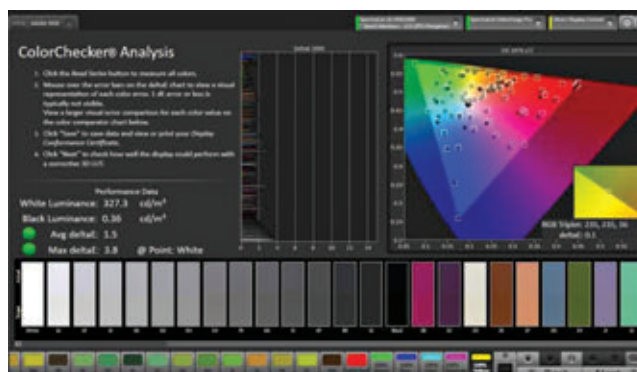
Along with the monitor, BenQ also sent us the



In the sRGB mode, the average delta error is just 1.4



**In the Display P3 mode, the average delta error is 1.8.
The maximum deviation is with 100% white**



In the AdobeRGB mode, we recorded an average delta error of just 1.5

SPECIFICATIONS:

Display: 24-inch, 2K (2560 x 1600), 16:10, IPS LCD, Matte finish, 60Hz | **Design:** Tilt: -5° – 20°; Swivel – 30°/30°; Pivot – 90°; Height Adjustment – 120mm | **VESA mount:** 100 x 100mm supported | **Connectivity:** Card reader, HDMI 2.0, Display Port 1.4, USB C (90W power delivery), USB B, 2x USB 3.1, Audio Jack | **Supported Colour modes:** Adobe RGB, B+W, DCI-P3, DICOM, Display P3, HDR, M-Book, Paper Color Sync, Rec.709, sRGB | **Chroma Sampling Support:** 4:4:4; 4:2:2; 4:2:0 | **Certification:** Calman Verified, Pantone Validated, Pantone SkinTone Validated | **Price:** ₹38,998

ScreenBar Halo for review.

Initially, I dismissed it as a luxury add-on, but it quickly proved to be a worthwhile upgrade I'd gladly pay for. The ScreenBar illuminates your workspace evenly without casting any light on the monitor!

You can turn off the room lights and enjoy balanced lighting from both the front and back of the ScreenBar. This helps reduce contrast glare between your monitor and surroundings, creating a more comfortable viewing experience, and can even help you customise your work to the environment it will be viewed in. The light also comes with a wireless control puck that feels premium and is quite convenient to use.

Should you buy it?

The BenQ SW242Q turned out to be a great option for photographers and also for casual video editors looking for high colour fidelity. It should be particularly appealing for graphic designers who may not require the extreme precision of top-tier colour calibration but still value a dependable colour-accurate monitor for their work.

The preset modes offer excellent colour accuracy and the monitor also supports hardware calibration for finer adjustments. The matte finish display makes it comfortable to work on for long hours. Besides the sharp 2K resolution and 16:10 aspect ratio further help improve productivity. A higher contrast would have made it a more appealing option for video editors as well. **■**